Strategy

Table of contents

Strategy **1**
- Purpose of this chapter . . . 1
- Position in the framework . . . 1
- How NSIs use this chapter . . . 2
- Strategy concepts in the SAF . . . 2
  - Relationships between the strategy elements . . . 2
- Capability Model . . . 3
  - Capability map . . . 4
  - Capability catalogue . . . 4
- Value Streams [**T1**] . . . 15
  - Value stream overview [**T2**] [**T3**] . . . 16
  - Value stream stages . . . 16
  - Capabilities per value stream [**T4**] . . . 18
- Resources [**T6**] . . . 19
- Courses of Action [**T6**] [**T7**] . . . 19
  - Reference strategies . . . 20

Strategy

Purpose of this chapter

The Strategy chapter translates motivation into what an NSI must be able to do and how it creates value. Motivation explains *why* change is needed. Strategy describes *what* the organisation needs: its capabilities, the resources behind them, the value streams they support and the courses of action that develop them.

These elements are deliberately independent of organisation structure, processes and systems. Departments, processes and applications change often. Capabilities and value streams change slowly. Anchoring architecture work in this layer lets an NSI compare itself with peers, plan investments over several years, and reorganise or replace technology without losing sight of what it must deliver.

Position in the framework

The Strategy layer shares the Strategy and Motivation area of the TOGAF ADM with the Motivation layer (see *Position in the framework* in the Motivation chapter). It receives direction from goals and outcomes. It gives direction to the business architecture: value stream stages are realised by business processes, and capabilities are realised by people, processes, information and technology in the lower layers.

PLACEHOLDER: Position of the Strategy layer between Motivation and the architecture domains

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In TOGAF terms, the Strategy chapter supports capability-based planning. Capabilities and value streams are part of the Architecture Vision (Phase A) and of the baseline and target Business Architecture (Phase B). Courses of action and resources return in Phases E and F, where the NSI decides how and in which order capabilities are developed.

How NSIs use this chapter

The capability model and the value streams in this chapter are a reference. Most NSIs perform the same core activities, so these elements are largely shared across the community. An NSI adopts, adapts or extends them, as it does the motivation elements.

The capability model is the most practical starting point. An NSI can assess the maturity of each capability, mark where its goals require improvement, and use the result to prioritise investment. Value streams show where in the production chain a capability creates value, and which stakeholders notice a weak capability first.

Resources and courses of action are specific to each NSI. The SAF explains these concepts, and the Toolkit provides templates and illustrative examples to record them.

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S02 Capability assessment and heatmap

Strategy concepts in the SAF

SAF section	ArchiMate element	Question it answers	Identifier	Toolkit
Capability Model	Capability	What must the NSI be able to do?	Capability number (e.g. 1.2.1)	SAF-TK-S01, SAF-TK-S02
Value Streams	Value Stream	Which sequence of stages creates value for a stakeholder?	VS-01 to VS-10	SAF-TK-S03
Resources	Resource	Which assets does the NSI have or need to perform its capabilities?	Defined by the NSI	SAF-TK-S04
Courses of Action	Course of Action	Which approach will the NSI take to develop its capabilities and reach its goals?	Defined by the NSI	SAF-TK-S05

The concepts form a chain. Capabilities are what the NSI can do. Resources are what it uses to do it: people, data, knowledge, technology and money. Value streams show where capabilities create value for a stakeholder. Courses of action describe how the NSI will strengthen its capabilities and resources to reach its goals.

Relationships between the strategy elements

Element	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Capabilities → Goals and outcomes (Motivation)	Capabilities realise goals and outcomes	Metadata management (2.1.2) realises enhanced data quality (SAF-O2)

Element	Relationship	Example in the SAF
Capabilities → Assessment (Motivation)	A capability maturity assessment is a structured form of assessment	A low maturity score for Statistical quality management (2.1.3)
Capabilities → Value streams	Capabilities enable value stream stages; a weak capability shows up as a weak stage	Primary data collection (1.2.1) enables VS-01.3 *Collect or Receive Data*
Resources → Capabilities	Resources are assigned to capabilities, which are performed with them	Staff with methodological expertise are assigned to Methodology (2.2.3)
Business functions and processes → Capabilities	Business functions and processes realise capabilities	Business function *Classify Data* realises Data standardisation (1.3.1)
Capabilities → Steady states	Capabilities produce or govern steady states	Data standardisation (1.3.1) produces State #2 Standardized Data
Value streams → Stakeholders and value (Motivation)	A value stream creates value for a stakeholder and delivers value elements	VS-06 creates value for users of statistics (SAF-ST02, SAF-ST03, SAF-ST06) and contributes to trust and legitimacy (SAF-V6)
Value streams → Steady states and processes	Each primary value stream produces one steady state; business processes realise its stages	VS-02 produces State #2; the execution processes of the Standardisation domain realise the stages of VS-02
Courses of action → Goals, outcomes and assessments (Motivation)	Courses of action serve goals and contribute to outcomes; assessments show why they are needed	A shared-platform strategy serves cost efficiency (SAF-G1); an assessment of SAF-D5 leads to a decision to retire legacy platforms
Courses of action → Principles (Motivation)	Courses of action apply principles	An application strategy applies SAF-P01
Courses of action → Capabilities, resources, value streams	Courses of action develop capabilities, configure resources and improve value streams	A metadata strategy develops Metadata management (2.1.2); a workforce strategy trains data engineers; a web-first collection strategy improves VS-01; a shared platform with partner NSIs develops IT infrastructure (3.2.5)
Constraints (Motivation) → Resources	Constraints limit which resources can be used	Public cloud may not be used for statistical microdata
Assessment (Motivation) → Resources	An assessment can record a resource gap	"Two of our three methodologists for small area estimation retire within two years"
Capability 4.1.2 *Policy and planning* → Courses of action	This capability produces the strategies	Translating the organisation strategy into domain strategies
Resources → Data and technology architecture	Data and technology resources are detailed in the lower layers	The data platform as a technology resource

Capability Model

A business capability is what a statistical organisation must be able to do to perform its mission, deliver value and achieve its objectives, independent of processes, organisational structures or technologies. Capabilities are the enabling building blocks of the organisation and give a stable, long-term view of its functional landscape. Each capability describes a specific business purpose and outcome, realised through one or more business functions and operationalised by business processes. Capabilities are therefore the conceptual bridge between strategy and execution: they translate strategic goals into operational competence.

- **They are stable.** Statistical quality management (2.1.3) remains essential whether quality checks are manual, automated or AI-supported. Processes and applications change; the capability stays. This makes capabilities the preferred unit for strategic planning, transformation roadmaps and multi-annual investment.
- **They are independent of organisation.** A capability can be spread over several departments, or one department can hold several capabilities. The capability model does not follow the organisation chart, which lets NSIs compare themselves with each other.
- **They are hierarchical.** High-level capabilities are decomposed into more detailed ones. In the SAF, *Data management* (2.1) is decomposed into, among others, *Metadata management* (2.1.2).

A capability view makes gaps visible: where a goal requires a capability that is weak or missing, investment is needed. Capabilities with a low maturity and a high contribution to goals become candidates for investment, and each capability can be traced to the processes, applications and platforms that realise it.

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S01 Capability model tailoring; SAF-TK-S02 Capability assessment and heatmap

Capability map

The SAF capability model has four main levels.

PLACEHOLDER: SAF capability map (ArchiMate)

ID	Main level	Description	Reference
1	Primary statistical capabilities	The ability to perform the statutory statistical tasks of an NSI.	GAMSO
2	Supporting data capabilities	The ability to manage statistical data and to carry out statistical research.	
3	Supporting business capabilities	The ability to make sure that the right people, information and resources are available to support the statistical and governance capabilities.	
4	Governance capabilities	The ability to give direction to the organisation, by setting its strategy and the framework within which change takes place.	GAMSO 1.2, Strategy and Leadership

Capability catalogue

1. Primary statistical capabilities

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.1	**Statistical design and build**	The ability to identify information needs and set up statistical processes to meet them.	GSBPM 5.2, Design

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.1.1	Needs inventory	The ability to identify the demand for statistical information and translate it into the societal questions the NSI will respond to. Needs are often identified through strategic relationships with users and stakeholders. The result is usually laid down in the NSI's multi-annual programme and the process that prepares it.	GSBPM
1.1.2	Design statistics product	The ability to translate information needs into concrete designs of datasets, process and workflow models, and rule sets and methodology, for the datasets that are released. This covers both the statistical product and the process that produces it. The process consists of process steps, rule sets for each step, the methodology, the process flow, the designs of the required datasets and the designs of shared connection points for reuse. If a required dataset is not available, a data collection assignment can follow. For primary data collection, designs then follow for sampling, questionnaires and similar instruments.	GSBPM, Design phase
1.1.3	Build statistics product	The ability to build, test and manage a statistical product until the end of its life cycle. The outputs of the design are assembled and configured into a complete operational environment in which the process can run.	GSBPM
1.2	**Data collection**	The ability to collect data for official statistics.	GSBPM 5.2, Collect

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.2.1	Primary data collection	The ability to set up and manage surveys up to completion, and to transfer the collected data and metadata for processing and analysis. Primary data collection uses one or more collection modes. The target population and sample size are set together with the client, based on the information need. Person surveys and business surveys are distinguished. A survey consists of, among other things, a sample, a questionnaire and an approach strategy.	ESS capability model
1.2.2	Secondary data collection	The ability to collect data and metadata from third parties for the production of statistics. Data that third parties have already collected is used as much as possible.	ESS capability model
1.3	**Processing**	The ability to process raw data into statistical microdata and statistics.	GSBPM, Process phase
1.3.1	Data standardisation	The ability to standardise data without loss of content. Standardisation covers data formats, category codes, linkage keys and units of measurement, such as weight, distance and time. It takes place directly after the raw data is received. Standardising as early as possible makes the rest of the process more efficient.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.3.2	Deriving variables and units	The ability to create new units, and values of new variables, from existing units and values of existing variables. New variables are usually derived to describe reality better. The data source was often not designed for that purpose.	
1.3.3	Check content	The ability to check datasets for irregularities, such as missing data, possible errors and outliers. Detected errors can lead to adjustment (see 1.3.4). They can also lead to a quality indicator that is used in quality reporting. Detected outliers lead to an outlier indicator, which matters for a good estimation method (see 1.3.5).	GSBPM
1.3.4	Adjusting and imputing	The ability to adjust incorrect values and to fill in missing values. Together with *Check content* (1.3.3), this capability is often called editing. Checks use editing rules, and adjustment is often based on imputation. Imputed values do not yet have to meet the editing rules. A final adjustment therefore often follows, with the editing rules as constraints.	GSBPM, ESS capability model

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.3.5	Estimating population parameters	The ability to estimate population parameters from microdata. Estimated population parameters often appear as observations, the cells, in a dimensional dataset such as a table. There are several estimation methods, including the traditional "weight and aggregate". Weights can be derived with several techniques. Sometimes weights are adjusted to give detected outliers less influence.	
1.3.6	Integrate statistics	The ability to integrate separate statistics into one consistent whole. Examples are integration systems such as the national accounts, sector accounts and labour accounts.	
1.3.7	Statistical disclosure	The ability to check datasets for privacy sensitivity and to adjust them where confidentiality would be violated.	GSBPM 6.4
1.4	**Analysis**	The ability to examine and understand data before it is disseminated. In NSIs, statistical analysis is also called statistical research. It draws connections or conclusions from relationships in the data, such as correlations.	GSBPM 5.2, Analyse
1.4.1	Statistical (output) analysis	The ability to validate, interpret and explain statistical output, and to finalise it for dissemination using shared methods and processes.	ESS capability model
1.5	**Dissemination**	The ability to manage the release of statistical products to internal and external users.	GSBPM 5.2, Disseminate

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
1.5.1	Publication management	The ability to manage the release of statistical output and related content according to release calendars, so that users have predictable and equal access.	ESS capability model
1.5.2	Promotion to use	The ability to promote statistical output to potential users, and to inform the press and other interested parties about it.	ESS capability model
1.5.3	Facilitate data access	The ability to make statistical data and metadata available to people and machines through multiple channels.	ESS capability model
1.5.4	Statistical information management	The ability to prepare and distribute publications about statistical output, such as press releases, interpretations and reports.	ESS capability model

2. Supporting data capabilities

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
2.1	**Data management**	The ability to manage data and metadata.	
2.1.1	Data lifecycle management	The ability to manage data throughout its life cycle.	
2.1.2	Metadata management	The ability to manage metadata throughout its life cycle.	ESS capability model
2.1.3	Statistical quality management	The ability to assess quality, put control mechanisms in place and start quality improvements across the statistical value chain.	
2.1.4	Statistical register management	The ability to set up, maintain and provide register services for collecting and integrating data. This includes the management of master data.	ESS capability model

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
2.2	**Research**	The ability to build and record knowledge about statistical methods, products, sources and techniques.	
2.2.1	Data source exploration	The ability to explore new data sources.	ESS capability model
2.2.2	Product innovation	The ability to create new statistical products from existing data sources, and to explore new data sources that are useful and important to users. Product innovation can precede the design of a statistical product (see 1.1.2).	ESS capability model
2.2.3	Methodology	The ability to investigate new methods for the statistical process.	
2.2.4	Data services	The ability to provide data for statistical or scientific research. This applies to both internal and external datasets. These services are provided through, among other things, microdata services.	
2.2.5	User research	The ability to collect and assess user needs, and translate them into statistical output.	

3. Supporting business capabilities

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
3.1	**Business operations**	The ability to manage personnel, purchasing and contracts, finance and housing, including the related systems and communication.	
3.1.1	Personnel management (HR)	The ability to make sure that enough qualified staff are available to carry out all business processes.	
3.1.2	Purchasing and contract management	The ability to acquire goods and services, and to monitor the agreements made with suppliers.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
3.1.3	Financial management	The ability to plan, organise, design, record and control the financial activities of the organisation.	
3.1.4	Communication management	The ability to communicate correctly with internal and external parties.	
3.1.5	Administrative support	The ability to support administrative tasks.	
3.1.6	Facility management	The ability to integrate people, place and process within the built environment. The description is based on ISO 41011. Facility management aims to improve the quality of life of people and the productivity of the core business.	ISO 41011
3.1.7	Legal support	The ability to handle requests and applications, assess agreements and advise on relevant laws and regulations.	
3.1.8	Information management and archive management	The ability to keep the organisation's information sustainably accessible (FAIR). This concerns information created in supporting and management processes, not statistical information from the primary statistical process.	
3.2	**Computerisation and automation**	The ability to translate the organisation's information needs into functionality of the information provision, and to keep information systems available to support business processes.	
3.2.1	Application development	The ability to develop applications in-house. This capability is needed to fill gaps in functionality that the statistical process requires.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
3.2.2	Functional management	The ability to manage applications so that they support business processes as well as possible. An example is collecting user requirements and translating them into new application functionality.	
3.2.3	Technical management	The ability to manage system software and applications. This covers installing, configuring and managing hardware and software so that it keeps working correctly, including all measures to resolve disruptions in time.	
3.2.4	Digital workplace management	The ability to manage the resources and services that staff use in their digital workplace. Examples are laptops and desktops, mobile devices, virtual desktops, video and audio conferencing, printing, VPN and proxy services.	
3.2.5	IT infrastructure	The ability to develop, maintain and manage IT infrastructure.	
3.3	**Security and privacy**	The ability to carry out all security and privacy activities.	
3.3.1	Privacy management [**S7**]	The ability to develop, manage, apply and test the NSI's privacy policy, in order to comply with privacy laws and regulations.	
3.3.2	Security planning	The ability to identify, analyse and plan measures to secure systems, networks, the organisation and its facilities.	
3.3.3	Security incident management	The ability to identify, analyse, respond to and recover from security incidents.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
3.3.4	Logical identity and access control	The ability to make sure that a person, organisation or IT facility can only use the automated functions for which access rights have been granted.	
3.3.5	Physical security and access control	The ability to provide controlled and safe access to buildings and spaces, and to keep the people and goods in them safe.	
3.3.6	IT security services	The ability to provide IT services that support information security. Examples are endpoint protection, PKI and network security management.	
3.4	**Customer and chain interaction**	The ability to interact with customers and chain partners: providing them with the right data and information, and receiving notifications, requests and data.	
3.4.1	Services management	The ability to design, develop, implement and manage the services that the organisation provides to customers and chain partners.	
3.4.2	Contact management	The ability to maintain relationships with customers and chain partners.	GAMSO 1.2, Manage Consumers **[S9]**
3.4.3	Service agreement	The ability to draw up, manage and enforce service agreements with clients and chain partners. Service agreements apply to clients that receive services from the NSI, such as access for external researchers or additional statistical services. They also apply to parties that supply data for primary or secondary data collection. If a party does not comply, the NSI can take enforcement action.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
3.4.4	Self-service	The ability to let customers and chain partners answer questions about the services they use, or make justified changes to them, without help from staff.	

4. Governance capabilities

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
4.1	**Strategy and leadership**	The ability to set the direction of the organisation and to manage change towards it.	GAMSO 1.2, Strategy and Leadership
4.1.1	Strategy and governance	The ability to develop a vision, and to set up and monitor the organisation and its management.	
4.1.2	Policy and planning	The ability to translate the strategy into concrete objectives, principles and plans.	
4.1.3	Change management	The ability to define and manage major changes, so that they contribute as much as possible to the objectives.	
4.1.4	Improvement management	The ability to manage daily operations, identify areas for improvement and implement improvements based on daily operations.	
4.1.5	Accountability	The ability to report to stakeholders inside and outside the organisation on how far obligations and agreements are met.	

ID	Capability	Description	Reference
4.1.6	Collaboration	The ability to maintain and strengthen strategic relationships with external stakeholders. Collaboration covers coordination with other statistical organisations and other external stakeholders. Within a statistical system, this coordination can follow a geographical hierarchy (local, regional, national, multinational) or a division of responsibilities between organisations. It includes identifying new opportunities for data exchange and integration. It also gives the statistical community opportunities to exchange knowledge, improve statistical infrastructure and practice, and influence statistical standards.	GAMSO 1.2, Manage Strategic Collaboration and Cooperation
4.1.7	Architecture Management	The ability to develop, maintain and govern the enterprise architecture of the NSI, and to use it in decisions on strategy, investment and change.	

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S01 Capability model tailoring

Value Streams [T1]

A value stream is a sequence of stages that together create an overall result for a stakeholder. Each stage adds a specific piece of value, and the value stream ends when the stakeholder receives the result. Value streams are seen from the stakeholder: they start with a need and end with value for someone, not following the organisation chart or the order of systems. They describe value, not work: a stage says *what value* is added, while *how* the work is done is described by business processes. And they are enabled by capabilities: each stage needs one or more capabilities.

Value streams and capabilities are two views on the same organisation. Capabilities show *what* the NSI can do; value streams show *where* that ability turns into value, which capabilities matter for which result, and which stakeholders notice a weak capability first. They also give the business architecture its structure: each stage is realised by business processes (see *Mapping to value stream stages* in Business Architecture), and the primary value streams follow the steady states of data. How each value stream works, stage by stage, is described in the Statistical Data Value Chain chapter.

Value stream overview [T2] [T3]

The SAF has ten value streams. Six primary value streams form the statistical value chain: each consumes a registered steady state and produces the next. Four supporting value streams run across the chain and provide governance, innovation, platforms and the connection with users.

ID	Value stream	Type	Receives value	Value created	Steady state in → out
VS-01	Data Acquisition and Ingestion	Primary	Statistical production; data providers	Trust and readiness: data acquired correctly and ready for use	#0 → #1
VS-02	Data Standardization and Integration	Primary	Statistical production; reusers of microdata	Coherence and comparability	#1 → #2
VS-03	Data Editing and Enrichment	Primary	Statistical production; methodologists	Reliability and analytical readiness	#2 → #3
VS-04	Estimation, Analysis and Statistical Modeling	Primary	Statistical product owners	Analytical insight and statistical credibility	#3 → #4
VS-05	Statistical Product Composition	Primary	Statistical product owners; users	Coherence and interpretability	#4 → #4 (approved)
VS-06	Dissemination and Service Delivery	Primary	Users: policy makers, researchers, media, businesses, the public	Impact and accessibility	#4 → #5
VS-07	Governance and Compliance	Supporting	Management, supervisory bodies, society	Integrity and accountability	Across all states
VS-08	Innovation and Methodological Development	Supporting	Statistical production	Continuous improvement	Across all states
VS-09	Infrastructure and Platform Enablement	Supporting	All value streams	Operational capability and continuity	Across all states
VS-10	Customer and Stakeholder Engagement	Supporting	Users, data providers, partners	Relevance and trust	#5 → (#6), feedback to VS-01

Value stream stages

Stage	Name	Value added
VS-01.1	Identify Data Needs and Sources	The information need is clear, and suitable sources are known
VS-01.2	Establish Data Agreements and Access Rights	Data can be obtained lawfully, under agreed conditions
VS-01.3	Collect or Receive Data	Data and its metadata are in NSI custody

Stage	Name	Value added
VS-01.4	Validate and Log Data Intake	The delivery is complete, intact and traceable
VS-01.5	Store and Register Raw Data Artefacts	Raw data is registered and available for reuse (State #1)
VS-02.1	Profile and Assess Data Structure	Differences from the target model are known
VS-02.2	Apply Standard Classifications and Formats	Data uses common codes, formats and identifiers
VS-02.3	Align Metadata and Semantics	Definitions and descriptions are consistent
VS-02.4	Validate Structural and Semantic Conformance	Conformance to standards is confirmed
VS-02.5	Register Standardized Artefacts	Standardised data is registered and available for reuse (State #2)
VS-03.1	Conduct Error Detection and Quality Diagnostics	Errors, duplicates, gaps and outliers are known
VS-03.2	Perform Data Editing and Correction	Incorrect values are corrected
VS-03.3	Impute Missing or Non-Response Data	Missing values are filled with documented methods
VS-03.4	Derive Additional Variables and Indicators	Data describes reality better than the source alone
VS-03.5	Perform Quality Evaluation and Versioning	Quality is documented, and processed microdata is registered (State #3)
VS-04.1	Confirm Estimation and Analytical Approach	The method fits the design and the purpose
VS-04.2	Apply Weighting and Calibration	Bias from sampling, non-response and coverage is reduced
VS-04.3	Estimate and Aggregate Data	Statistics and indicators are available
VS-04.4	Perform Model-Based Analysis	Model-based results complement direct estimates
VS-04.5	Validate and Document Results	Results are sound and documented (State #4)
VS-05.1	Select and Integrate Source Datasets	Relevant results are brought together
VS-05.2	Construct Composite Indicators or Indices	Indices, ratios and aggregates are available
VS-05.3	Perform Consistency and Coherence Checks	The product is internally consistent
VS-05.4	Generate Analytical and Interpretive Outputs	Results are explained and visualised
VS-05.5	Approve and Register Statistical Products	The product is approved for release (State #4, approved)
VS-06.1	Plan Dissemination and Access Strategy	Target users, channels and formats are set
VS-06.2	Prepare Data for Dissemination	Output is disclosure-safe and in the right format
VS-06.3	Publish and Provide Access Services	Users can find and access the output (State #5)
VS-06.4	Support and Engage Users	Users understand and use the output correctly
VS-06.5	Monitor Usage and Feedback	The NSI knows how its output is used
VS-07.1	Define Governance Frameworks and Policies	Rules for data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality and quality are set

Stage	Name	Value added
VS-07.2	Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms	Applicable rules are known and translated into procedures
VS-07.3	Implement Data and Metadata Governance	Ownership, stewardship and lineage are assigned
VS-07.4	Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators	Quality and compliance status is visible
VS-07.5	Audit, Certify and Report Compliance	Compliance is demonstrated
VS-07.6	Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms	Governance keeps up with new rules and lessons learned
VS-08.1	Identify Innovation Needs and Opportunities	Promising developments are known
VS-08.2	Conduct Research and Proof-of-Concepts	Ideas are tested in a limited scope
VS-08.3	Evaluate Methodological Soundness and Feasibility	Only sound and feasible innovations proceed
VS-08.4	Develop and Document New Methodologies or Tools	Innovations are ready for reuse
VS-08.5	Integrate Innovation into Production Environments	Innovations run in production under governance
VS-08.6	Promote Knowledge Sharing and Capability Building	Staff can apply the new methods
VS-09.1	Define Digital and Technical Requirements	Infrastructure needs follow from business needs
VS-09.2	Design Platform and Infrastructure Architecture	Platforms are designed for storage, processing, integration and secure access
VS-09.3	Provision and Configure Platforms	Environments are available with the required controls
VS-09.4	Enable Integration and Orchestration Services	Processes and services are connected
VS-09.5	Ensure Performance, Security and Continuity	Platforms are reliable and protected
VS-09.6	Evolve and Modernise the Technical Ecosystem	The technical landscape stays current
VS-10.1	Identify and Segment Stakeholders	The NSI knows its users, providers and partners
VS-10.2	Collect and Analyse User Needs	Needs are translated into requirements
VS-10.3	Define and Manage Service Portfolios	Services and products match the needs
VS-10.4	Deliver Services and Manage Relationships	Users and partners are served
VS-10.5	Engage and Communicate with Stakeholders	Stakeholders understand the output
VS-10.6	Monitor Impact and Satisfaction	The NSI knows its impact and acts on it

Capabilities per value stream [T4]

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view of capabilities serving value stream stages

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S03 Value stream tailoring and capability mapping

Resources [T6]

A **resource** is an asset that an organisation owns or controls. Resources are what the organisation uses to perform its capabilities. A capability without the right resources exists on paper only. Resources make the capability model realistic: a maturity assessment that only looks at processes misses the most common bottleneck, not enough people with the right skills or no access to a needed data source. Linking resources to capabilities shows where a capability depends on a single expert, an outdated platform or an agreement that expires.

The SAF distinguishes six types of resources:

Type	Examples in an NSI
People and skills	Methodologists, data engineers, subject-matter statisticians, architects
Data and information	Registers, survey data, administrative data deliveries, classifications, metadata
Knowledge	Statistical methods, process documentation, quality frameworks
Technology	Data platforms, processing tools, collection systems, secure processing environments
Financial	Structural budget, project funding, international grants
Relationships and agreements	Data sharing agreements, partnerships with other NSIs, supplier contracts

Resources are owned or controlled: a resource is something the NSI has, or has secured through an agreement, such as access to administrative data under a provision agreement. They are limited, so they force choices between capabilities. And they are shared: a data platform supports collection, processing and dissemination at the same time. For an NSI, data is a resource in its own right. Registers, long time series and trusted relationships with data providers are often harder to replace than any system.

Resources are specific to each NSI, and the SAF does not list them. Technology resources are described in more detail in the application and technology architecture, and data resources in the data architecture.

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S04 Resource profile

Courses of Action [T6] [T7]

A **course of action** is an approach or plan for configuring capabilities and resources to reach a goal. It answers the question *how will we get there?* Goals say where the NSI wants to go and capabilities say what it must be able to do; courses of action describe the choices the NSI makes to close the gap. Recording them explicitly prevents a common problem: programmes that each make sense on their own, but pull the organisation in different directions.

Courses of action range from broad to specific. ArchiMate calls the broad, long-term ones **strategies** and the narrower, shorter-term ones **tactics**. There is no hard line between the two. A strategy is usually broken down into several tactics, and tactics are realised by developing capabilities and resources. Courses of action are choices: "collect data web-first" rules out paper-first, and a plan without a choice is not a course of action. They serve goals, and one that serves no goal needs a justification. They build, strengthen, share or retire capabilities and resources.

Strategy, architecture and roadmap are related but different. A strategy sets the direction and the main choices. The architecture describes the structure that results. A roadmap sets the order and timing of

the changes. Courses of action are specific to each NSI, and the SAF does not define them. Choosing a reference model for the data value chain, such as the Steady-State or the Medallion architecture (see *Reference Models for the Statistical Data Value Chain*), is itself a course of action.

Reference strategies

The following published strategies and guidance documents can serve as reference when an NSI develops its own strategies.

Document	Organisation	Type	Relevant for
Statistics Canada Data Strategy	Statistics Canada	Data strategy of an NSI	Data strategy; shows links to IT, cloud, privacy and metadata strategies
Data Strategy	Office for National Statistics (UK)	Data strategy of an NSI	Data strategy
ABS Data Strategy 2025–2030	Australian Bureau of Statistics	Data strategy of an NSI	Data strategy
Data Strategy of the Secretary-General	United Nations	Data strategy of an international organisation	Data strategy
Cloud for Official Statistics (2024)	UNECE	Guidance	Cloud strategy
Privacy-Enhancing Technologies Guide	UN Committee of Experts on Big Data and Data Science	Guidance	Privacy and confidentiality strategy

Toolkit: SAF-TK-S05 Strategy and course of action canvas